

Psychology 450: Syllabus

Learning Theory: Spring 2026

Instructor	Dr. Campese	Phone	812.488.2531
Office Location	120 Hyde Hall	Email	vc44@evansville.edu
Course Meeting Days and Time	4:15-5:30pm 122 Hyde Hall	Office Hours	By appointment
Course Mode	In Person		

Course Information

Catalog Description:

This course will introduce students to fundamental concepts in the psychological sub-field of learning theory. This field has a long tradition of empirical analysis, and the course will cover the beginnings of this field as well as its current state. Contemporary issues and how biological sciences have infused with learning theory to stimulate advances in neuroscience will be covered.

Credit Hour Policy Statement:

This class meets the federal credit hour policy of 1 hour of class with an expected 2 hours of additional student work outside of class each week for approximately 15 weeks for each hour of credit, or a total of 45-75 total hours for each credit.

Course Learning Outcomes:

By the end of the course, it is my hope that you will a) be familiar with fundamental concepts and terms, b) know how psychologists go about establishing scientific knowledge, c) be able to think critically about several claims or ideas and weigh supporting or refuting evidence accordingly, and e) learn how to access original sources.

Program Learning Outcomes:

To determine whether we have met our goals, students will be asked to draw upon the knowledge they have acquired on exams as well as presentations. These will be used to demonstrate the ability to consider evidence with regards to empirical questions and unresolved questions in the literature. This will require students to obtain and utilize original sources independently.

Required Materials:

Learning and Behavior: A contemporary synthesis 2nd Ed, 9780878933853, ME Bouton

Methods of Instructions:

The most efficient way to approach this class is to read the assigned text material before **watching the videos**. Arrange group sessions with classmates to discuss material and test your knowledge against that of your peers when possible. Use the publisher companion site, if available, to get as many examples as you need to feel comfortable with the work. If you are lost, **ZOOM** me!

Withdrawal and Attendance policies:

Attendance will be taken regularly. Failing to attend class will negatively impact your performance. Attendance is subject to my records, there will be no negotiations over when you did or did not come to class. It is your responsibility to make sure you are accounted for each day you are in class. Attendance will periodically be reported

to the registrar. If you have more than 2 unexcused absences, your final grade will drop by 1/3 of a letter; 4+ unexcused absences and you will be withdrawn from the class. Excused absences include University activities (e.g., athletic competitions – not practice) of which I am pre-informed via formal signed documentation and emergencies (e.g., medical, or family) which also require that you submit documentation to me, via email. Remember, if you miss too many classes, you will fail. Even if you have excuses, you cannot succeed in this class without attendance. You may need to miss a game or two just as you miss a class or two. Remember, your priority should always be academics. Please scan your doctor note or team schedule and attach to your supplicative message. More information can be found here: <https://www.evansville.edu/registrar/calendars.cfm>.

Grading Criteria:

Final grades will be based on a weighted average of performance across the following grading components.

1. **Five Exams:** In person exams - while the final exam will be cumulative, the others will be independent. All are averaged together and worth **40%** of the overall grade. See schedule for details.
2. **Quizzes & Section Reviews:** Based on textbook readings, quizzes (ten of them) & section reviews (five of these) are worth **15%** of the overall grade. See schedule for details (accessed via blackboard).
3. **Two Essays:** Reactions to podcast content and connections to text concepts are worth **15%** of the overall grade. See blackboard for assignment details.
4. **Biographical/Research Presentations:** Each student will give a lecture on a significant figure in the field. See below for details. This counts for **15%** of the overall grade. See blackboard for assignment details.
5. **Final Paper:** Based on the research conducted for the biographical presentation, summarize the historical, scientific and personal. Worth **15%** of the overall grade. See blackboard for assignment details.

All assignment prompts and submission portals are accessed via the content page of blackboard. Each submittable is due by midnight on the module close date by which the item appears below in the schedule. **Late assignments are not accepted. Exams, homework, and papers must be submitted by the deadline for credit to be earned. I do not offer extra credit or drop any grades, please do not ask.**

Grade Distribution

95 – 100	A	83 – 86	B	73 – 76	C	66 – 60	D
90 – 94	A-	80 – 82	B-	70 – 72	C-	0 – 59	F
87 – 89	B+	77 – 79	C+	67 – 69	D+		

Honor Code:

All students at the University of Evansville agree to the University honor code: *I will neither give nor receive unauthorized aid, nor will I tolerate an environment that condones the use of unauthorized aid.*

Course AI Policy:

In this course, submission of any work that is not entirely your own is considered academic dishonesty. The use of generative AI tools such as ChatGPT are prohibited and constitute a violation of academic integrity as examples of unauthorized aid.

Online Course Policies

Technology Policy:

Participation in an online or hybrid course requires regular access to a computer with an internet connection. While some class activities can be completed on a mobile device, many cannot and it is the responsibility of the student to ensure that access to a computer and the internet is maintained throughout the entirety of the course.

If a student cannot complete an assignment because of a technology difficulty, the student is expected to first contact the instructor via the preferred method of communication to ensure that the instructor is made aware of the situation. The student can then contact the Office of Technology Services (OTS), through the online [Help Desk](#) or by phone at (812) 488-2077, to submit an incident and work toward a resolution.

Communication Policy:

In an online course, it is expected that there will be regular and substantive interaction between the faculty member and the student, as well as among students. The instructor may initiate communication with students and it is expected that students reciprocate this communication. Students are also expected to actively participate in course discussions and collaborate with other students according to course policies and assignment instructions to achieve course learning outcomes.

Student Verification Policy:

It is required that a student registered for a course is the same student who participates in the course and receives course credit. UE's policy for verifying student identity can be found [here](#).

University Policy Statements

Disability Policy:

The University of Evansville is committed to providing an accessible and supportive environment for students with disabilities. It is the policy and practice of the University of Evansville to make reasonable accommodations for students with properly documented disabilities. Students should contact Disability Services at 812-488-2663 to seek services or accommodations for disabilities. Written notification to faculty from Disability Services is required for academic accommodations.

Institutional Equity and Title IX

UE is committed to fostering an atmosphere free from harassment and creating an inclusive campus for all members of the University community regardless of their sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, race, religion, ethnicity, country of origin, ability, or veteran status. All Faculty members are considered Responsible Employees and required to report instances of discrimination, harassment, or sexual violence to the Office of Institutional Equity

You may also choose to speak to a Confidential Resource about your experience. Confidential Resources at the University include:

Counseling Services: 812-488-2663, counselingservices@evansville.edu

Crayton E. and Ellen Mann Health Center: 812-488-2033, healthcenter@evansville.edu

Spiritual Formation Coordinator: 812- 488-5265, spiritualformation@evansville.edu

If you or someone you know has been harassed, assaulted, or discriminated against you can find the appropriate resources by contacting the Assistant Director of Institutional Equity and Title IX Coordinator: email titleix@evansville.edu ; phone (812) 488-5261. For more information visit <https://www.evansville.edu/offices/titleix/policy.cfm> .

Incomplete Grade Policy:

All coursework is to be completed within the semester it is attempted. The grade report of "I" will be given only when justified by personal crisis or legitimate sickness; otherwise, the missing scores will be entered as zeroes. As outlined in the catalog, the following circumstances must exist as well for the receipt of an "I": (1) the student's other work in the course would earn a passing grade, and (2) the outstanding task can be completed without further class attendance. A request for an "I" must be presented in writing by either you or the Dean of Students. If granted, and "Incomplete Grade Contract" will then be drawn up and signed by both the instructor and the student. The catalog continues: Outstanding course work normally should be completed within six weeks of the class ending, but the instructor may allow up to one year from the end of the term for which the "I" grade is granted. It is the student's responsibility to have this deficiency removed within the contractually agreed upon time or within one year, whichever is less. If no grade change has been submitted by the instructor after the maximum one-year grace period, the registrar is authorized to change all grades of "I" to "F".

Non-discrimination Statement

The University of Evansville expects all members of its community to treat each other with respect and civility. Harassing behaviors directed towards any member of our community will not be tolerated. As part of its commitment to non-discrimination, the University specifically prohibits harassment based on any other characteristics set forth in its nondiscrimination statement as follows: including race, color, gender, gender identity and expression, sexual orientation, creed or religion, national origin, age, disability, veteran status and all federally protected groups/classes. Any form of harassment undermines the mission of the University and negatively impacts the University community as a whole. For more information contact the [Center for Inclusive Excellence](#).

Campus Safety

All members of the UE community are automatically enrolled in the Ace Alerts Emergency Alert System. When the system is activated, emergency notification information is sent in the following manner: calls to campus IP phones, text messages, emails, campus housing speaker system, active threat sirens (non-weather related), digital signage, and AlertUS desktop on campus-owned computers.

To contact the Office of Public Safety:

Emergencies: 812-488-6911

Non-emergencies: 812-488-2051

Complaints, Grievances, and Appeals

The University of Evansville seeks to resolve all student concerns in a timely and effective manner through policies and processes documented in the University [Course Catalog](#) and [Student Handbook](#).

Student Resources

Academic Services: Contact the Center for Academic Advising to connect with academic support services including supplemental instruction, tutoring, and time management and study skills help.

Blackboard Guides: Blackboard is the University of Evansville's course management system for online courses. Guides on using Blackboard can be found within [MyUE](#).

Writing Center : The Writing Center provides access to writing resources, appointments for one-on-one writing help, and assistance with any stage of the writing process.

Counseling Services: Counseling Services provides general, short-term counseling that assists students in identifying barriers and setting goals while improving coping strategies to achieve personal and academic goals.

University Libraries: Conduct research, access resources, and contact librarians for any research related help.

Lecture, Exam and Presentations Schedule (tentative):

Date	Day	Agenda
13-Jan	T	Introduction to course
15-Jan	TH	Learning Theory introduction
20-Jan	T	Respondents v Operants
22-Jan	TH	Learning and Adaptation
27-Jan	T	Determinants of Learning
29-Jan	TH	Nuts & Bolts of CC 1
3-Feb	T	Review for Exam 1
5-Feb	TH	Exam 1 (Ch 1 & 2)
10-Feb	T	Nuts & Bolts of CC 2
12-Feb	TH	Theories of Conditioning 1
17-Feb	T	Theories of Conditioning 2
19-Feb	TH	Theories of Conditioning 3
24-Feb	T	Review for Exam 2
26-Feb	TH	Exam 2 (Ch 3 & 4)
3-Mar	T	Theories of Conditioning 4
5-Mar	TH	What Ever Happened to Behavior?
10-Mar	T	Spring Break
12-Mar	TH	Spring Break
17-Mar	T	Generality of Laws
19-Mar	TH	Instrumental Modulation
24-Mar	T	Review for Exam 3
26-Mar	TH	Presentations 1
31-Mar	T	Exam 3 (Ch 4 & 5)
2-Apr	TH	Easter Break
7-Apr	T	Presentations 2
9-Apr	TH	Presentations 3
14-Apr	T	Presentations 4
16-Apr	TH	Exam 4 (Ch 6-8)
21-Apr	T	Presentations Fin
23-Apr	TH	Review for Final
28-Apr	T	Final Exam (Cumulative)

Module Closures (readings, papers, quizzes & section reviews):

Module	Read	Quiz	Section Reviews	Paper	Close Date
1	Ch 1	1	1 (Ch 1-2)	-	2-Feb
	CH 2	2			
2	Ch 3	3	2 (Ch 3)	-	27-Feb
3	Ch 4	4	3 (Ch 4)	RL Essay 1	20-Mar
4	Ch 5	5	4 (Ch 5-7)	RL Essay 2	10-Apr
	Ch 6	6			
	Ch 7	7			
5	Ch 8	8	5 (Ch 8-10)	Bio Paper	1-May
	Ch 9	9			
	Ch 10	10			